

Geography of Colombian Life Satisfaction

Sunday 26th April, 2026 12:50

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This paper is about geography of Colombian happiness.¹ We start with departments/provinces, then move to cities/municipalities, and finally finish up with urban-rural and farmers.

about colombia boilerplate like 2nd biggest land mas and pop in lat am? one of the happiest that table from fools paradise

and need about geography like goog 'gepgraphy of colombia' in goog scholar and normal goog

about roads etc ranked one of thw worst and airports

We know little about colombian happiness: my paper, stiupid burger as cited in my paper, and that govt report i cite in my paper!! do skim thru it!!

1 Data

We use a great source of data ECV. We use 2023 edition.

2 Departments/Provinces

there are 166k missing out of 242k, we conduct robustness check in appendix using 2021 wave

the map is below, table including number of obserrvations per province is in appendix

unhappy: West (poor Choco, and Southern Cauca and Narino) and East Guainia and Vichada. In 2021 (see appendix) Choco and Cauca were still relatively unhappy, but slightly happier.

Happy caffetero: Caldas, Risaralda, Quindio—in 2021 there were slight differences (see appendix) but overall Caffetero was happy too. And also happy Santander. Then slightly less happy Norte de Santander, Cesar and Atlantico. In 2021 (see appendix) Santander, Cesar and Atlantico were less happy.

¹Following usual practice in social indicators research terms happiness and life satisfaction are used interhcangeably, and specifically we mean cognitive and evaluative life satisfaction rather than affective happiness.

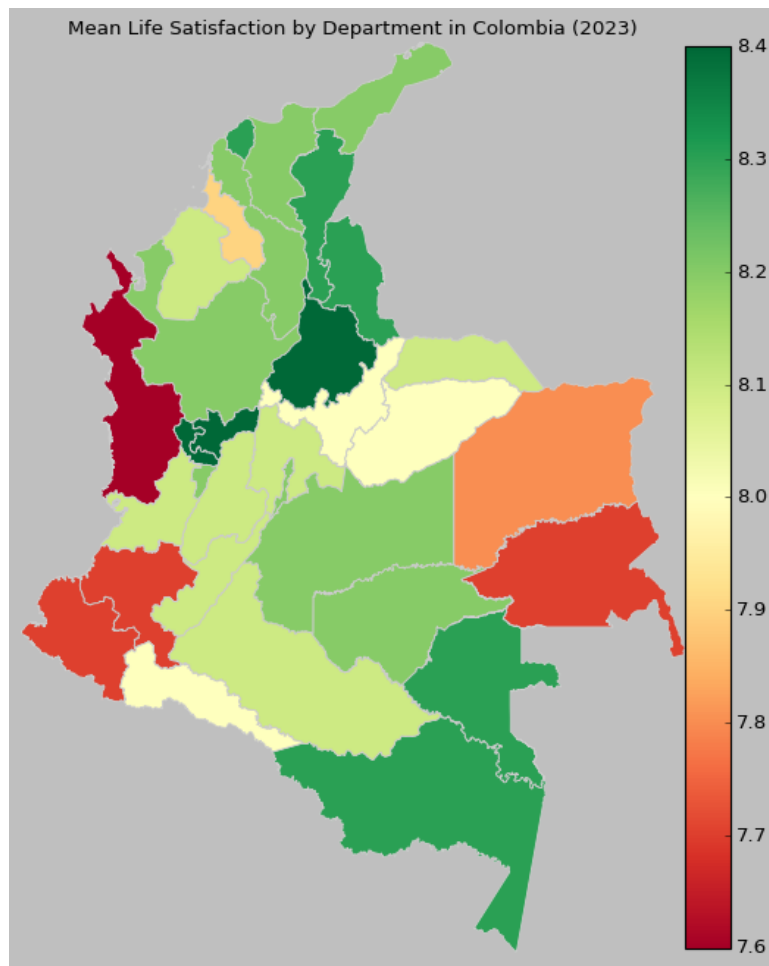


Figure 1: Similar to 2021 robustness/sensitivity check in appendix except: small sample Amazonas and Vaupés, both South-Eastern at 8.3 in 2023 v 7.6 in 2021, a .7 difference. Sencond largest differences: Santander and Putumayo increased by .4 from 2021 to 2023.

3 Cities/Municipalities

166k/242k missing, again robustness/sensitivity check in appendix with 2021 ecv

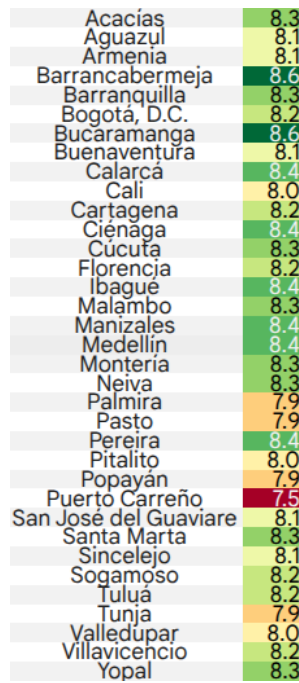


Figure 2

Santander is one of the happiest departments, and so 2 santander largest cities shine: Bucaramanga and Barrancabermeja at 8.6. Bucaramanga was less happy in 2021 at 8.1. Another happy region coffeeero has many happy cities: Calarcá, Pereira, Manizales, and Armenia (Armenia was even happier in 2021). Other happy cities include 2nd largest Medellín, Ibagué, and Ciénaga (Ciénaga was less happy in 2021 at 7.9). The least happy is remote Western Puerto Carreño at 7.5, and several cities at 7.9: Tunja, and Southern cities: Palmira in Valle de Cauca, Popayán in Cauca, and Pasto in Nariño.

4 Urban-Rural and Farmers

While most developed countries cities are unhappy and indeed unhappy city is a common pattern across the world (Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2021), it is not always the case in developing countries.

here boilerplate from happy col unahhpy bog: that cities are growth engines Glaeser (2011) and O'Sullivan (2009) and developing countries like Colombia do need economic growth hence role for cities is greater than in already developed countries

and there is paradox of happy peasant and unhappy millionaire Graham (2009)

though not so much in Colombia, urban and rural are about same happy, except by income: bar chart by income category bu urb rur as in raman

ONLINE APPENDIX (Supplementary Online Material (SOM))

[note: this section will NOT be a part of the final version of the manuscript, but will be available online instead]

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. tabstat ls, by(lwd7) stat(mean sd) format(%9.1f)
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Summary for variables: ls
Group variable: lwd7 (RECODE of lwd (do what you like))

lwd7	Mean	SD
0-4	5.6	2.7
2	7.6	2.3

3	7.6	1.8
4	8.0	1.5
5	7.8	1.9
6	8.2	1.5
7	8.9	1.5
Total	8.3	1.9

.9

5 Reestimation Using 2023 ECV

2021 May be biased say bc of covid, especially that it peaked in colombia in 2021 <https://coronavirus.jhu.edu/region/colombia>(by 2023 used in the paper it pretty much cleared). But it a useful robustness check, if covid didnt change much , then it should be pretty stable

and it was quite high mortality in col <https://coronavirus.jhu.edu/data/mortality>

5.1 Departments/Provinces

Again as said in the paper, overall results are similar to 2023 reported in the body of the paper, except small sample Amazonas and Vaupés, both South-Eastern and with 8.3 in 2023 v 7.6 in 2021, a .7 difference. Sencond largest differences are for Santander and Putumayo which increased by .4 from 2021 to 2023.

Table 1: Life satisfaction by department.

department	life isfaction 2023	sat- total 2023	obs	non- missing life satisfaction 2023	mean life satisfaction 2021	total 2021	obs	non ing satisfaction 2021	miss- life	2023-2021
Amazonas	8.3	276	245	7.6		423	365		0.7	
Antioquia	8.2	5499	4729	8.3		6036	5060		-0.1	
Arauca	8.1	974	773	8.1		1103	868		0	
Atlántico	8.3	3144	2311	8.0		2338	1799		0.3	
Bogotá, D.C.	8.2	4688	3446	8.1		5337	3810		0.1	
Bolívar	8.2	2584	2258	8.1		2495	2156		0.1	
Boyacá	8.0	4129	3649	7.8		4638	4122		0.2	
Caldas	8.4	2822	2555	8.2		3335	3005		0.2	
Caquetá	8.1	2547	2018	7.9		2846	2249		0.2	
Casanare	8.0	1749	1370	8.1		2051	1457		-0.1	
Cauca	7.7	2580	2244	7.9		2572	2287		-0.2	
Cesar	8.3	2224	1717	8.0		1833	1510		0.3	
Chocó	7.6	857	754	7.9		1016	913		-0.3	
Cundinamarca	8.1	3818	3322	7.8		4233	3684		0.3	
Córdoba	8.1	2706	2240	8.0		2226	1933		0.1	
Guainía	7.7	327	273	7.4		350	274		0.3	
Guaviare	8.2	700	457	8.0		621	411		0.2	
Huila	8.1	2961	2322	8.0		2999	2407		0.1	
La Guajira	8.2	951	750	7.9		988	736		0.3	
Magdalena	8.2	2458	2096	8.0		2110	1710		0.2	
Meta	8.2	3683	2752	8.1		3862	2817		0.1	
Nariño	7.7	2284	2034	7.4		2847	2492		0.3	
Norte de Santander	8.3	2499	2028	8.2		2587	2171		0.1	
Putumayo	8.0	950	752	7.6		1272	1012		0.4	
Quindío	8.2	2085	1658	8.4		2186	1785		-0.2	
Risaralda	8.4	1634	1353	8.3		1996	1663		0.1	
San Andrés y Providencia	8.4	28	25	8.2		29	26		0.2	
Santander	8.4	3790	3194	8.0		4153	3574		0.4	
Sucre	7.9	1798	1399	7.8		1899	1467		0.1	
Tolima	8.1	3564	3215	8.0		4257	3770		0.1	
Valle del Cauca	8.1	4892	4093	8.1		5268	4421		0	
Vaupés	8.3	265	245	7.6		288	267		0.7	
Vichada	7.8	515	455	7.6		584	482		0.2	

5.2 Cities/Municipalities

Table 2: Life satisfaction by department.

municipality name	p756s2	mean life satisfaction 2023	non ing miss- life satisfaction 2023	mean life satisfaction 2021	non ing miss- life satisfaction 2021	2023-2021 diff
Buga	76736.0	NaN	NaN	8.0	215	NaN
Espinal	73168.0	NaN	NaN	7.8	220	NaN
Mariquita	73411.0	NaN	NaN	7.9	201	NaN
Ocaña	54498.0	NaN	NaN	8.2	200	NaN
San Vicente del Caguán	18592.0	NaN	NaN	8.1	240	NaN
Armenia	63001.0	8.1	668.0	8.5	681	-0.4
Buenaventura	76147.0	8.1	412.0	8.3	279	-0.2
Cartagena	13001.0	8.2	591.0	8.4	572	-0.2
Facatativá	25307.0	8.1	200.0	8.3	222	-0.2
Palмира	76520.0	7.9	319.0	8.1	332	-0.2
Popayán	19001.0	7.9	225.0	8.1	232	-0.2
Tuluá	76834.0	8.2	303.0	8.4	307	-0.2
Tunja	15001.0	7.9	270.0	8.1	241	-0.2
Calí	76001.0	8.0	985.0	8.1	1108	-0.1
Pitalito	41551.0	8.0	293.0	8.1	288	-0.1
Cúcuta	54001.0	8.3	573.0	8.3	553	0.0
Manizales	17001.0	8.4	462.0	8.4	567	0.0
Medellín	5001.0	8.4	905.0	8.4	959	0.0
Puerto Carreño	99773.0	7.5	225.0	7.5	215	0.0
San José del Guaviare	95001.0	8.1	246.0	8.1	231	0.0
Villavicencio	50001.0	8.2	982.0	8.2	990	0.0
Acacías	50313.0	8.3	229.0	8.2	233	0.1
Bogotá, D.C.	11001.0	8.2	3446.0	8.1	3836	0.1
Calarcá	63130.0	8.4	244.0	8.3	257	0.1
Pereira	66001.0	8.4	524.0	8.3	677	0.1
Santa Marta	47001.0	8.3	225.0	8.2	218	0.1
Sincedejo	70001.0	8.1	222.0	8.0	275	0.1
Valledupar	20001.0	8.0	339.0	7.9	274	0.1
Barranquilla	8001.0	8.3	1363.0	8.1	1116	0.2
Florencia	18001.0	8.2	575.0	8.0	630	0.2
Ibagué	73001.0	8.4	478.0	8.2	549	0.2
Pasto	52001.0	7.9	244.0	7.7	309	0.2
Yopal	85001.0	8.3	264.0	8.1	240	0.2
Montería	23001.0	8.3	465.0	8.0	372	0.3
Neiva	41001.0	8.3	417.0	8.0	436	0.3
Riosucio	17614.0	8.5	203.0	8.2	203	0.3
Sogamoso	15759.0	8.2	236.0	7.9	367	0.3
Aguachica	20011.0	8.6	202.0	8.1	215	0.5
Bucaramanga	68001.0	8.6	798.0	8.1	842	0.5
Ciénaga	47189.0	8.4	234.0	7.9	252	0.5
Magangué	13430.0	8.3	205.0	7.8	207	0.5

5.3 Urban-Rural and Farmers

References

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